

Caroline Edwards

Product Designer · Simplifying digital journeys · Building trust through accessible design

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Product Designer who turns difficult digital journeys into services people can navigate with confidence. I've led UX across publishing and public-sector platforms for Centaur Media, Macmillan, EMAP, Condé Nast, Lincolnshire and Isle of Anglesey County Councils. Combining research, accessibility and product thinking to make complex experiences simpler, clearer and easier to use.

Good design starts with understanding people, not just their data

CORE SKILLS

User Research & Synthesis	User Flows	Inclusive & SEND-Informed Design
Usability Testing	Wireframing & Prototyping	Design Systems & Components
Evidence-Based Design	Mobile & Native App Design	Stakeholder Collaboration
Service Design & Journey Mapping	Interface Design	Workshop Facilitation
Design QA & Developer Handoff	Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA & 2.2)	Agile Product Delivery
Interaction Design	Information Architecture	AI-Assisted Design & Prototyping

RECENT PROJECTS

Private Healthcare (NDA) · Redesigned a high-stakes patient appointment journey through research, journey mapping, prototyping and usability testing.

HabitHero · Ran three rounds of usability testing to refine a healthcare mobile product, then developed a 20+ screen design system and Figma Dev Mode handoff to support implementation.

Arbor (Self-initiated) · Used interviews, heuristic evaluation and usability testing to identify and redesign the information architecture behind school event ticket purchasing.

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer · Professional Development Programme

King's College London. February 2026 - Present

- Led end-to-end product design from discovery through interactive prototype, using research, testing and stakeholder insight to prioritise the problems worth solving.
- Challenged assumptions through interviews, usability testing and research synthesis, turning evidence into clearer priorities, hypotheses and design decisions.
- Applied WCAG 2.1 AA principles to interaction patterns and journeys, addressing critical usability barriers identified through testing.
- Balanced user needs, stakeholder priorities and technical constraints to turn validated ideas into practical, feasible solutions.

- Established reusable Figma components, design patterns and interaction models, improving consistency and enabling clearer developer collaboration.

SEND Experience Support (Applied Inclusive Design)

Hampshire County Council. July 2021 - Present

- Observed how children with autism, SEND and complex behavioural needs interacted with digital learning tools in real classroom conditions, uncovering barriers not apparent from intended use.
- Identified accessibility and communication barriers through behaviour and workarounds, adapting information, interactions and support around individual needs.
- Developed structured support plans with teachers, external agencies and families, balancing multiple perspectives to create a consistent approach.

Service Designer & Operations Lead

Everybody Pilates. March 2016 – August 2021

- Grew membership by 150% and annual revenue beyond £100k by identifying customer journey friction and redesigning key service experiences around member needs.
- Investigated the customer journey through staff and member feedback across four locations, identifying gaps between intended service and delivery. Developed standardised processes, training and operational guidance to address them.
- Mentored a direct team of six and staff across all franchise locations, supporting adoption of new processes and consistent service delivery as the business grew.

Lead Interaction Designer

Abacus e-Media. August 2006 – May 2016

Progressed from Junior to Lead Interaction Designer over nearly a decade at an award-winning digital agency, working across education, publishing, public sector, B2B and B2C products.

- Led UX, interaction and visual design from discovery through delivery across content-heavy websites, SaaS products and digital services, balancing user needs with commercial and technical requirements.
- Designed responsive digital experiences and reusable interaction patterns across publishing brands including EMAP, UBM, Centaur Media, Macmillan and Condé Nast, balancing distinct audiences and business models while creating consistency across devices; EMAP titles subsequently saw mobile traffic shift from roughly 50:50 to 80:20 versus desktop.
- Established shared design systems across client platforms, working with developers and QA to create a consistent experience across desktop, tablet and mobile while enabling new products to be delivered more efficiently.
- Influenced clients through workshops, user research and usability testing, helping publishers adopt shared patterns while preserving the brand differences important to their audiences and commercial goals.
- Delivered public-sector digital transformation, replacing Derbyshire County Council's paper recruitment process and moving 60% of 5,000 annual vacancies online, reducing a two-week delay and saving close to £190,000 a year.

- Collaborated closely with developers to overcome accessibility limitations in third-party software systems, finding practical solutions around technical constraints while maintaining a consistent, accessible experience across the wider service.
- Mentored junior designers while helping establish the studio's approach to UX, accessibility and design standards.

Interactive Learning Designer

BBC. July 2005 – September 2005

Created interactive numeracy content for BBC Jam for children aged 5–7, working with educators and curriculum specialists to turn curriculum objectives into engaging, accessible digital learning experiences.

Interactive Designer

Big Pink. May 2005 – July 2005

Simplified complex medical information for healthcare organisations including GSK and Pfizer, creating intuitive, accessible websites and interactive campaigns within highly regulated environments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

E-Commerce Innovation of the Year · 2013 · The Grocer, PPA Customer Direct Awards, William Reed Business Media - Lead UX/UI Designer

Digital Innovation of the Year · 2013 · TES Connect, PPA Awards, TSL Education – UX/UI Designer

Digital Data Product of the Year · 2012 · TES Connect, PPA Awards, TSL Education – UX/UI Designer

Government Website of the Year · 2011 · Lincolnshire County Council - Lead UX/UI Designer

IT Project Innovation Award · 2011 · Lincs to the Past - Lead Designer

IT Project Innovation Award · 2009 · C4YP - Lead Designer

Business Website of the Year · 2009 · TES Connect, AOP Awards - UX/UI Designer

EDUCATION

Interactive Media Production BA (Hons) · Bournemouth University 2003 - 2006

Computer Animation & Visualisation Foundation | Bournemouth University 2002 - 2003

Graphic Design BTEC Diploma · Reading College 2001 - 2002